I went back to Frogmore. From there, remotely, over the next few days, I took part in the drafting of a final statement, which went out January 18, 2020.

The Palace announced that The Duke and Duchess of Sussex had agreed to "step back," that we'd no longer "formally" represent the Queen, that our HRH titles would be in "abeyance" during this transitional year—and that we'd offered to reimburse the Sovereign Grant for refurbishments to Frogmore Cottage.

A firm "no comment" on the status of our security.

I flew back to Vancouver. Delicious reunion with Meg, Archie and the dogs. And yet, for a few days, I didn't feel fully back. Part of me was still in Britain. Still at Sandringham. I spent hours glued to my phone, and the internet, monitoring the fallout. The ire directed at us by the papers and the trolls was alarming.

"Make no mistake, it's an insult," cried the *Daily Mail*, which convened a "Fleet Street jury" to consider our "crimes." Among them was the Queen's ex–press secretary, who concluded, with his fellow jurors, that we should hereafter "expect no mercy."

I shook my head. No mercy. The language of war?

Clearly this was more than simple anger. These men and women saw me as an existential threat. If our leaving posed a threat to the monarchy, as some were saying, then it posed a threat to all those covering the monarchy for a living.

Hence, we had to be destroyed.

One of this lot, who'd written a book about me and thus provably depended on me to pay her rent, went on live TV to explain confidently that Meg and I had departed from Britain without so much as a by-your-leave to Granny. We'd discussed it with no one, she said, not even Pa. She announced these falsehoods with such unfaltering certainty that even I was tempted to believe her, and thus her version of events quickly became "the truth" in many circles. *Harry blindsided the Queen!* That was the narrative that took hold. I could feel it oozing into history books, and I could imagine boys and girls at Ludgrove, decades hence, having that hogwash rammed down their throats.

I sat up late, brooding on it all, going over the progression of events and asking myself: What's the matter with these people? What makes them like this?